



2027 CUB SCOUT WEEKEND — LEADERS GUIDE



PIRATE CREW ADVENTURES · “Ahoy, Mateys!” · Camp Lawton · 3-Day Weekend

Camp Dates	Cub Scout Weekend: Fri Jun 25 – Sun Jun 27, 2027 (3-day weekend)
Camp Contact	Catalina Council office
Theme	Pirate Crew Adventures · “Ahoy, Mateys!” · Campsites = Ships
Property	Camp Lawton · Catalina Council, BSA · USFS National Forest Land
Check-In	Friday Jun 25, 2:00–3:00 PM · Back vehicles in · No vehicles inside camp
Check-Out	Sunday Jun 27, 10:55 AM+
Program Groups	Group A: Tigers & Wolves (ages 5–8) · Group B: Bears (ages 8–9) · Group C: Webelos & AOL (ages 10–11)
No Aquatics	Camp Lawton has no pool or waterfront. All activities are land-based.
NCAP Status	NCAP 2026 Compliant · PD-102 Cub Scout Program Design · USFS Special Use Permit
Future Dates	2028: Cub Weekend Jun 23–25 (Fri–Sun) · 2029: Cub Weekend Jun 22–24 (Fri–Sun)

CRITICAL INFORMATION — READ BEFORE ARRIVAL

- 3-DAY WEEKEND: Camp runs Friday afternoon through Sunday mid-morning per NCAP PD-102. Not a full week.
- NO AQUATICS: Camp Lawton has no pool or waterfront. There is no swimming, boating, or water program. Do not bring swim gear expecting an aquatics program.
- NATIONAL FOREST LAND: Camp operates under a USFS Special Use Permit. Leave No Trace is mandatory. Fire restrictions may prohibit campfires at any time — check daily with staff.
- VEHICLES: Not permitted inside camp beyond the parking area. Back into spaces. Emergency vehicle access must remain clear at all times.
- MEDICATIONS: All prescription medications must be surrendered to the Camp Health Officer at check-in. Stored securely per NCAP HS-508.
- YOUTH PROTECTION: All adults must have current YPT on file. Two-deep leadership required at all times. No one-on-one adult/youth contact.
- CLIMBING WALL (Saturday only): Per GSS gss08, Climbing Wall is restricted to Group C (Webelos & AOL) only. Tigers, Wolves, and Bears are prohibited from the climbing area.

I. Welcome to Pirate Crew Adventures

Welcome aboard, Cub Scouts and families! Camp Lawton has been transformed into a fleet of pirate ships for 2027. Every campsite is a Ship, every den is a Pirate Crew, and every scout will earn their sea legs over a fun-packed Friday-to-Sunday weekend.

This guide covers everything your den and family need for a safe, successful weekend. All programming is land-based, age-appropriate per NCAP PD-102, and designed to be fun first — with advancement tucked into the adventure. Please read this guide fully before arrival and share key sections with your scouts and their families.

Program Groups — Age-Based Rotations

Scouts rotate through activity stations in three age-based groups. All groups do the same activities — the complexity of instructions, worksheets, and challenge level is adjusted by rank per NCAP PD-102.

Group A	Tigers & Wolves (ages 5–8) · Focus: fun, creativity, simple skills
Group B	Bears (ages 8–9) · Focus: skill development, teamwork, basic navigation
Group C	Webelos & AOL (ages 10–11) · Focus: leadership, advanced skills, independent problem-solving

ONE GSS-REQUIRED AGE RESTRICTION

- CLIMBING WALL (Saturday only): GSS gss08 restricts the Climbing Wall to Group C (Webelos & AOL) only.
- Tigers, Wolves, and Bears are NOT permitted in the climbing area — no exceptions.
- Group C does Climbing Wall as a dedicated Saturday afternoon session with certified supervision.

II. Arrival & Check-In

Check-In Procedure

- Arrive FRIDAY June 25 between 2:00 PM and 3:00 PM. Do not arrive before 2:00 PM — staff setup is still in progress.
- Back your vehicle into your parking space. Required for emergency vehicle egress — not a suggestion.
- Vehicles are NOT permitted inside camp beyond the designated parking area.
- Proceed to the check-in station with: unit roster, health forms, and all prescription medications.
- All medications surrendered to Camp Health Officer at check-in. Returned Sunday morning at check-out with signature (NCAP HS-508).
- Receive Ship Assignment (campsite), leader packet, program group assignment, and weekend schedule.
- Proceed to campsite for Ship Setup (3:30–4:30 PM). Safety Brief begins at 4:30 PM — mandatory for all scouts, leaders, and families.

Required Documentation — Bring for Every Participant

- BSA Annual Health & Medical Record Parts A, B, and C (within 12 months) for every participant
- Signed unit roster with emergency contact information
- Special dietary needs or medical accommodation documentation
- All prescription medications in original labeled containers with dosage instructions
- Proof of current Youth Protection Training for all registered adult leaders

ELECTRONIC HEALTH RECORDS — NCAP HS-503 (Revised Jan. 1, 2026)

- Camp Lawton is building electronic health record capability per HS-503. Paper forms remain fully acceptable for 2027.
- If submitting health records electronically in advance, confirm receipt with the Camp Director before your arrival.
- All health information is confidential and accessed only by the Camp Health Officer and emergency medical personnel.

III. Camp Policies

National Forest Land — USFS Special Use Permit

Camp Lawton operates on National Forest land under a USFS Special Use Permit. Per NCAP AO-801, USFS permit conditions legally prevail over camp preferences. All of the following apply to scouts, leaders, and families:

- **LEAVE NO TRACE:** Pack out all trash. Stay on established trails. Do not disturb native vegetation or wildlife.
- **CAMPFIRES:** Subject to USFS fire restrictions at all times. Check with staff every morning. Always have a no-flame alternative ready.
- **GROUND DISTURBANCE:** No digging, trenching, or staking without Camp Ranger approval. Follow posted instructions for tent stake placement.
- **PETS:** No pets within camp boundaries without USFS approval. Service animals with current documentation are permitted.
- **FIREARMS & FIREWORKS:** Prohibited on National Forest land. No personal firearms may be brought to camp.
- **WASTE DISPOSAL:** Dispose of all waste at designated central waste stations. Pack out trash. Never pour liquid waste on the ground.
- **WILDLIFE & FOOD:** Store all food and scented items properly. Report unusual wildlife to Camp Ranger immediately.

Youth Protection

- Two-deep leadership required at all times. No one-on-one adult/youth contact, ever.
- All adults in camp must be registered Scouting America members with current Youth Protection Training on file.
- Showers, latrines, and changing areas are separated by gender and age group.
- Report any suspected abuse immediately to the Camp Director and local law enforcement.

Health & Safety

- Camp Health Officer on duty all weekend hours (NCAP SQ-405). After-hours backup CHO designated — ask at check-in.
- First aid kits at: Health Lodge, each program area, and carried by trek leaders.
- Buddy System (NCAP HS-511) required for all scout movement throughout camp — brief your scouts at arrival.
- Emergency assembly point posted at your Ship and at each program area entrance.

IV. Program Overview — Weekend Schedule

The Cub Scout Weekend is a 3-day program. Friday is arrival and welcome campfire. Saturday is the full pirate adventure day with activity rotations across all three age groups. Sunday is closing ceremony and departure. See the Cub Leader Schedule document for minute-by-minute detail.

Friday, June 25 — Arrival & Welcome Campfire

2:00 – 3:30 PM	Fleet Arrival & Check-In · Surrender medications to CHO
3:30 – 4:30 PM	Ship Setup — Tent Pitching & Campsite Organization
4:30 – 5:30 PM	Safety Brief & Ship Tour (ALL must attend)
5:30 – 5:50 PM	Evening Flags
6:00 – 7:00 PM	Galley Dinner — Captain's Welcome Feast
7:00 – 7:30 PM	► <i>Post-Meal Cleanup Buffer (30 min)</i>
7:30 – 8:30 PM	★ Staff Campfire — Scouts & Families Watch (subject to USFS fire status)
8:40 PM	Taps — Cubs Lights Out

Saturday, June 26 — Full Pirate Adventure Day

6:30 AM	Reveille
6:40 – 7:00 AM	Morning Flags
7:10 – 7:45 AM	Mess Hall Feast — Breakfast
7:45 – 8:15 AM	► <i>Post-Meal Cleanup Buffer</i>
8:15 – 8:45 AM	Campsite Clean-Up & Inspection
8:55 – 10:25 AM	Activity Block A — Pirate Ship Building & Flag Design (PS-208 / PS-223)
10:35 – 11:05 AM	Snack Break & Free Play
11:15 AM – 12:45 PM	Activity Block B — Grand Treasure Hunt! Orienteering (PS-212)
12:55 – 1:40 PM	Buccaneer Lunch
1:40 – 2:10 PM	► <i>Post-Meal Cleanup Buffer</i>
2:10 – 2:40 PM	Leader's Meeting + Scout & Family Free Time (concurrent)
2:50 – 3:20 PM	Rest Hour / Story Time
3:30 – 5:00 PM	Afternoon Activity — Cannon Raid! & Walk the Plank (PS-223) · Group C: Climbing Wall (GSS gss08)
5:10 – 6:10 PM	Pirate Skit Practice & Knot Tying Review (kit approval required before youth campfire)
6:20 – 6:40 PM	Evening Flag Ceremony
6:50 – 7:35 PM	Mess Hall Feast — Dinner
7:35 – 8:05 PM	► <i>Post-Meal Cleanup Buffer</i>

8:05 – 9:05 PM	★ Youth Campfire — Scouts & Families Perform (pre-approved content only)
9:15 – 9:45 PM	Cracker Barrel & Fellowship
9:55 PM	Taps — Lights Out

Sunday, June 27 — Final Roundup & Departure

6:30 AM	Reveille
6:40 – 7:00 AM	Final Morning Flag Ceremony
7:10 – 7:45 AM	Farewell Breakfast
7:45 – 8:15 AM	► <i>Post-Meal Cleanup Buffer</i>
8:15 – 9:45 AM	Ship Pack-Up & Final Officer Check (USFS LNT — leave site cleaner than found)
9:55 – 10:45 AM	Closing Ceremony & Weekend Awards (beads, patches, recognition)
10:55 AM+	Homeward Bound — Family Departure (retrieve medications from CHO, 10 MPH speed limit)

Note: 10-minute transitions occur between every activity. 30-minute post-meal cleanup buffers occur after every meal. These are non-negotiable for safe and orderly camp.

Saturday Activity Stations (Age-Appropriate by Group)

Saturday is the full rotation day. All three groups rotate through pirate-themed stations across the morning and afternoon activity blocks. Complexity is adjusted by rank per NCAP PD-102.

Activity Station	NCAP Reference & Safety Notes
Pirate Flag Design	PS-208 — Handicraft; age-appropriate materials
Pirate Ship Building	PS-223 — STEM craft; LNT: pack out all materials
Walk the Plank	PS-223 — Balance beam; max 12" height; spotter required for ages 5–8
Grand Treasure Hunt	PS-212 — Orienteering; within USFS permit boundary; buddy system
Cannon Raid!	PS-223 — Dry beanbag toss; land-based only; no water
Island Creatures Walk	PS-211 — Nature walk; LNT on USFS land; established trails only
Sailor's Knots	PS-212 — Knot tying & navigation; age-appropriate complexity
Swab the Deck Archery	PS-213 — Certified instructor required; one range open at a time
Climbing Wall (Group C ONLY)	GSS gss08 — Webelos & AOL ONLY. Tigers/Wolves/Bears prohibited from climbing area.

Campfire Nights

Friday — Staff Campfire	Staff perform skits, songs, storytelling. Scouts & families watch. Sets the weekend theme. Subject to USFS fire restrictions.
Saturday — Youth Campfire	Scouts & families perform pre-approved skits, songs, stories. Kit approval by staff required Saturday afternoon (5:10–6:10 PM).

Bead Program

Scouts earn themed beads throughout the weekend for demonstrated skills in: Knots, Navigation, Outdoor Skills, First Aid, and Service. Leaders distribute beads from their leader packet. Bead criteria cards are included in the packet and also available at the Trading Post.

V. Leader Logistics

Saturday Leader’s Meeting

Held Saturday at 2:10 PM at the Captain’s Quarters (location posted in leader packet). While leaders meet, scouts and families have supervised free time at the Trading Post, campsite, or fellowship areas. Meeting runs 30 minutes. All unit leaders are expected to attend.

Saturday Afternoon — Kit Approval

Saturday afternoon (5:10–6:10 PM) scouts organize their campfire kits for the Saturday Youth Campfire. All skit content, songs, and stories must be reviewed and approved by a staff member before performance. This is a BSA requirement (PD-112 skit screening) and non-negotiable. Leaders should work with their scouts on content earlier in the day.

Departure (Sunday)

- Complete campsite inspection and check-out. Leave site cleaner than found (USFS LNT requirement).
- Return all issued equipment (radios, first aid kits, site keys) to the Trading Post.
- Retrieve all medications from the Camp Health Officer with signature (HS-508).
- Receive departure clearance from Camp Director before leaving.
- Exit via main entrance only. Speed limit in camp and on access roads: 10 MPH.

VI. NCAP 2026 Quick Reference for Cub Leaders

The standards below are most relevant to your den’s experience at camp. Staff are responsible for full compliance — this table helps you understand what to expect and what is required of your unit.

Standard	Topic	What It Means for Your Unit
PD-102	Cub Scout Program	Fun-based, age-appropriate activities required. Adventure over advancement. 3-day weekend format compliant.
PS-208	Handicraft	Staff trained on craft safety. All equipment safe. Scouts get safety instruction before each station.
PS-211	Nature Programs	LNT principles throughout. USFS land: stay on trails.

PS-212	Outdoor Skills	Knot tying, navigation, orienteering — age-appropriate per rank.
PS-213	Archery Range	Certified supervision required. One range open at a time. Equipment checked per session.
PS-223	Other Programs	Walk the Plank, Ship Building, Cannon Raid, Treasure Hunt all have approved syllabi on file.
HS-501	Youth Protection	Current YPT required for all adults. Two-deep at all times.
HS-503	Health Records	BSA Health & Medical Record Parts A, B, C required for all participants.
HS-508	Medications	All prescriptions to CHO at check-in. No self-medication by youth.
HS-511	Buddy System	Required for all scout movement. Enforced at all program areas.
AO-801	USFS Permits	Permit conditions prevail. LNT mandatory. Ground disturbance prohibited without approval.
PD-107	Outdoor Ethics	LNT principles apply throughout camp and all outdoor activities.
PD-112	Program Safety	All campfire skit content staff-approved before performance. Incidents reported to Camp Director.
GSS gss08	Climbing Wall	Restricted to Webelos & AOL only. Tigers/Wolves/Bears prohibited from climbing area.

Appendix: Leave No Trace — National Forest Land Requirements

All activities at Camp Lawton must follow Leave No Trace principles as required by the USFS Special Use Permit and NCAP PD-107. Please brief your scouts on these principles at arrival.

LNT Principle	What It Means at Camp Lawton
1. Plan Ahead & Prepare	Know your activity boundaries. Check fire restrictions every morning with staff. Brief scouts on USFS rules before going out.
2. Travel on Durable Surfaces	Stay on established trails and cleared paths. Do not cut through native vegetation. Keep groups together.
3. Dispose of Waste Properly	Pack out all trash — including craft materials, food wrappers, and broken equipment. Dispose of all waste at designated central waste stations.
4. Leave What You Find	Do not collect rocks, plants, feathers, or natural materials. Do not move or stack rocks. Leave the forest as you found it.

5. Minimize Campfire Impacts	Use established fire rings only. Check USFS fire restriction status daily. Fully extinguish all fires — cold to the touch. Have a no-flame backup planned.
6. Respect Wildlife	Observe animals from a distance. Never feed wildlife. Store all food and scented items properly. Report unusual wildlife to Camp Ranger.
7. Be Considerate of Others	Respect quiet hours. Keep noise levels appropriate. Leave program areas cleaner than you found them. Share trails courteously.